

Offboarding Procedure

Final Pay

Departing employees receive their final paycheck, including any unused PTO payout, on the next regularly scheduled payroll date after their last day, or sooner where required by state law (several states require final pay immediately or within 72 hours for involuntary terminations, and Payroll tracks each state's specific deadline in the offboarding checklist tool).

Equipment Return

All company equipment (laptop, monitor, badge) must be returned within 5 business days of the last day of employment via prepaid shipping label provided by IT. Unreturned equipment may be deducted from final pay where permitted by state law, and IT remotely disables account access on the last day of employment regardless of whether equipment has yet been physically returned.

Benefits After Departure

Health benefits end on the last day of the month of departure. COBRA continuation coverage information is mailed within 14 days, and the departing employee has 60 days from the COBRA notice to elect continuation coverage, which if elected is retroactive to the day after Contoso Corp coverage ended so there is no coverage gap.

Exit Interview

Departing employees are invited to an optional exit interview with HR, conducted separately from the employee's manager, to gather candid feedback on their experience at Contoso Corp. Exit interview notes are anonymized and aggregated for department-level trend reporting; individual comments are not shared with the departing employee's former manager.

Employees who decline the live exit interview may instead complete a short written survey covering the same topic areas; either format is entirely optional, and declining both has no effect on final pay, references, or eligibility for rehire.

Rehire Eligibility

Employees who leave in good standing are generally eligible for rehire and may reapply for future openings at any time; their prior tenure does not automatically carry forward for benefits or PTO accrual purposes, since rehire is treated as a new hire date unless a specific rehire agreement states otherwise.

Non-Disclosure Reminder

As part of offboarding, HR reviews the confidentiality obligations from the Data Security and Confidentiality Policy with every departing employee, which continue to apply after departure regardless of the reason for leaving. Departing employees are asked to confirm in writing that they have not retained any Confidential data on personal devices or accounts.

Reference Requests

Contoso Corp provides only neutral employment verification (dates of employment and title) to external reference requests by default; a departing employee may request that their direct manager provide a more detailed personal reference, which is entirely the manager's individual choice to give, not a company-provided service.